MealCare — User resources

Meal planning for older adults and caregivers. This document describes how to open MealCare, what you need, and what you can do in the app.

Live app: https://meal-planner-for-elderly.vercel.app/

System requirements

• **Device:** computer, tablet, or smartphone with a modern web browser.

• **Browser:** recent Chrome, Edge, Firefox, or Safari.

• **Internet:** stable connection (the app runs online).

• **Account:** To use the MealCare application, a user account is required.

Users can create an account using their email address and a password through the registration option on the login page.

After submitting the registration form, the system may send a verification email to confirm the user's identity. The user must open their email inbox and follow the verification link provided.

Once the account is verified, the user can log in and access all features of the application.

If the verification email is not received, users should check their spam or junk folder.

How to open MealCare

1. Open your web browser.
2. Go to https://meal-planner-for-elderly.vercel.app/

How to use MealCare (step-by-step)

1. Create or log in to your account Enter your email and password.
   Complete email verification if required.
2. Set up your profile Add your dietary preferences, allergies, and health conditions.
   This information is used to personalise meal recommendations.
3. Create a weekly meal plan Select meals for each day (breakfast, lunch, dinner).
   The system shows suitable options based on your profile.
4. View your meal plan Review your weekly plan and track completed meals.
5. Use the shopping list, the system automatically generates a shopping list based on your selected meals.
   You can check off items or scan products using barcode feature.
6. Update your profile or plan You can modify your preferences or change meals at any time.

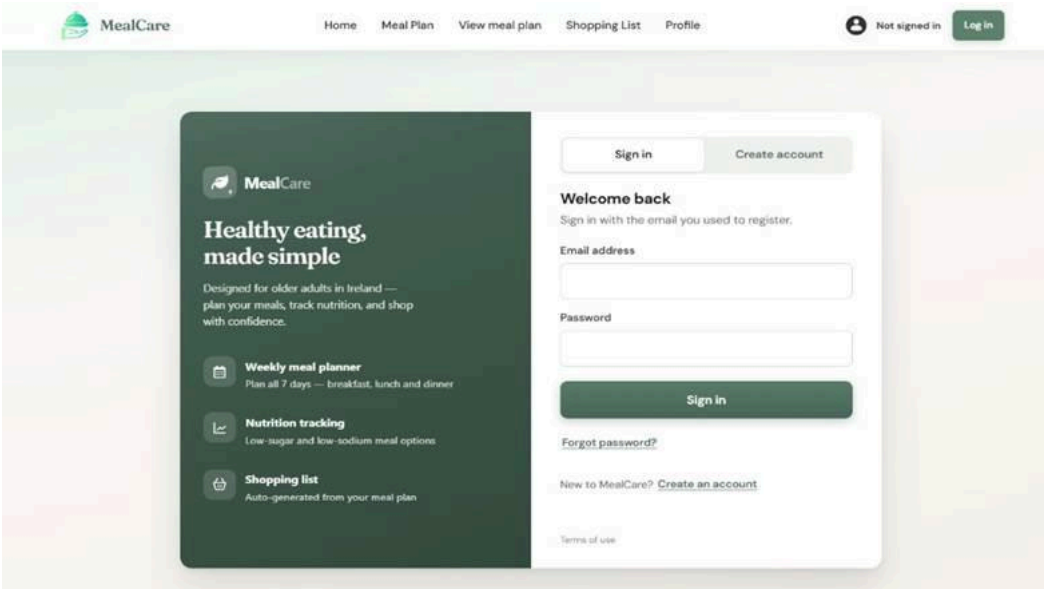
What you can do

- **Home:** start screen after you sign in.
- **Meal Plan:** choose meals for the week (breakfast, lunch, dinner).
- **View meal plan**: see the week, mark meals eaten, open recipes.
- **Shopping List:** from your plan; filter by aisle; optional barcode scan.
- **Profile:** your details, energy estimate, diet and health preferences.
- **Caregiving:** only if your account is set up as a caregiver (linked care recipient).

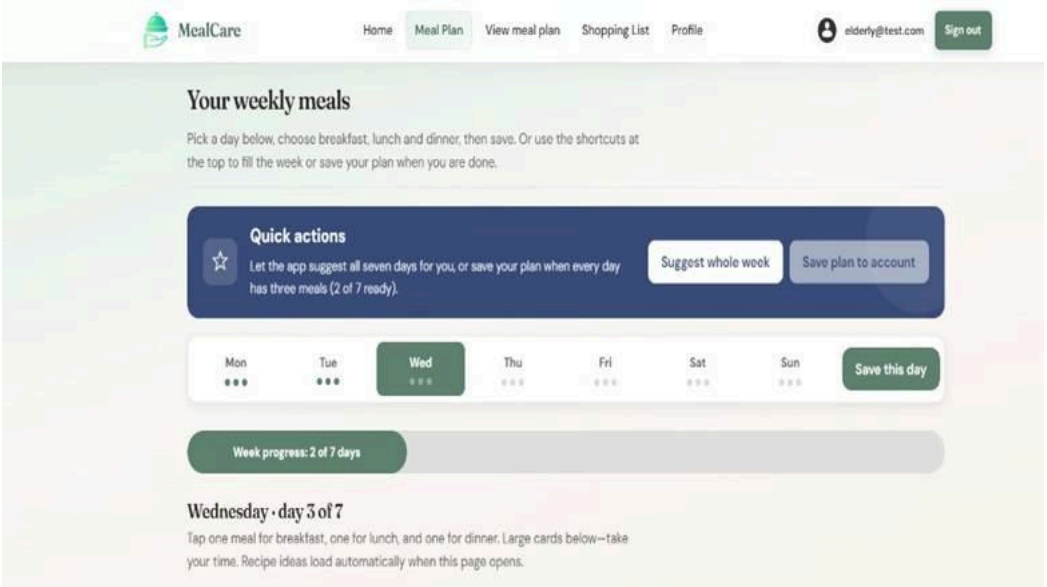
If you are a caregiver, you may see “Viewing” in the bar to switch between yourself and someone you support.

Screenshots

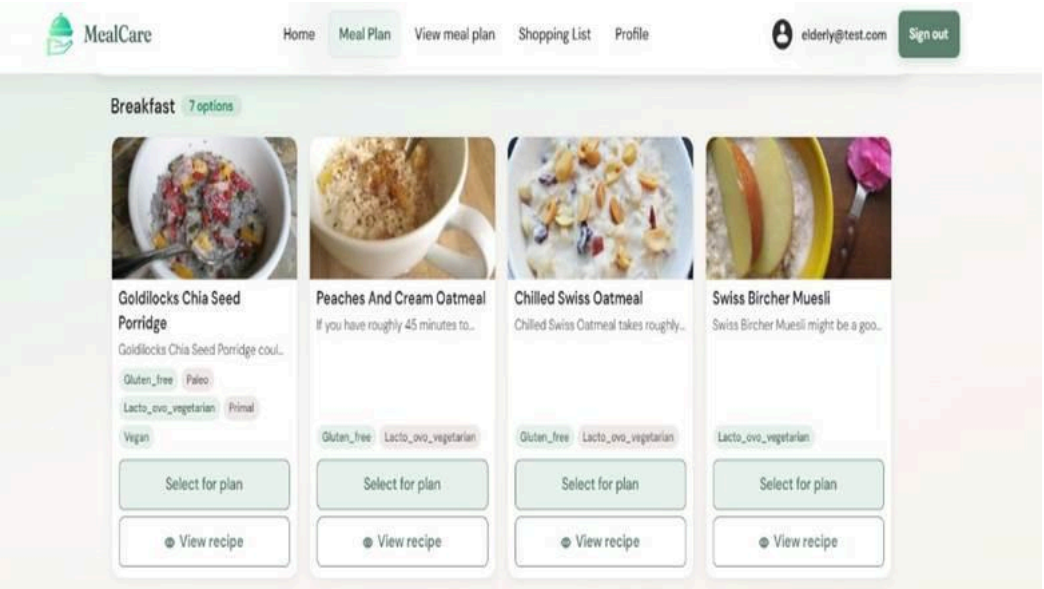
1. Sign in — Sign in or create an account.



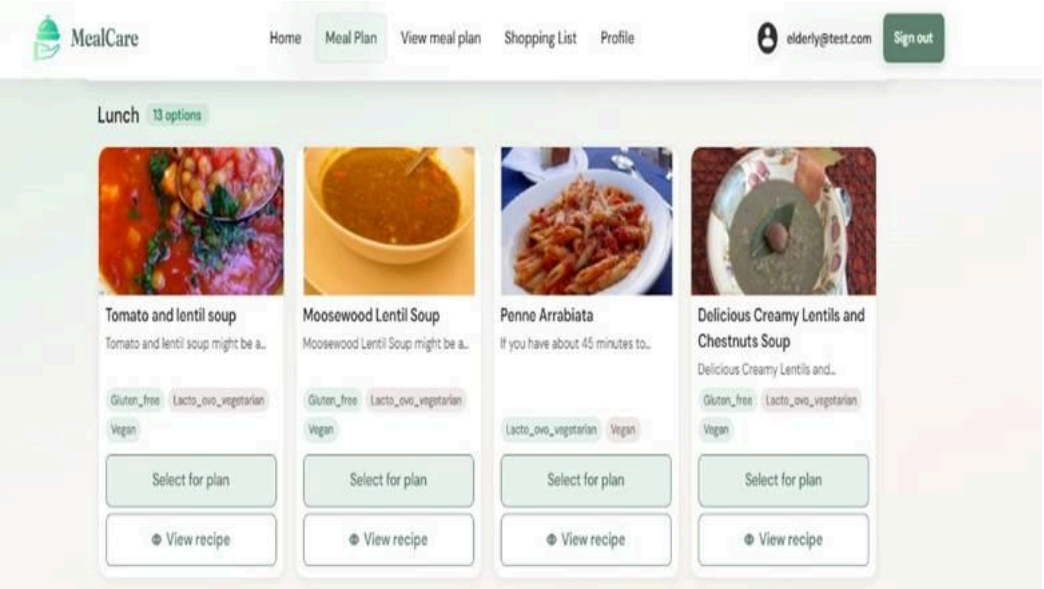
2. Meal Plan — pick a day, Quick actions, week progress.



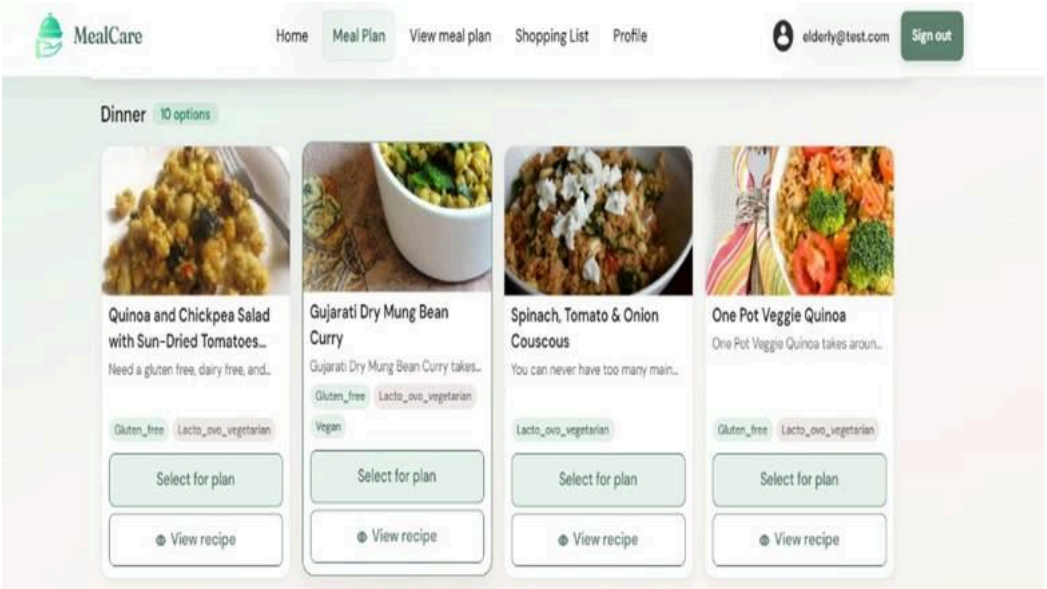
2.1. Meal Plan — breakfast options (Select for plan).



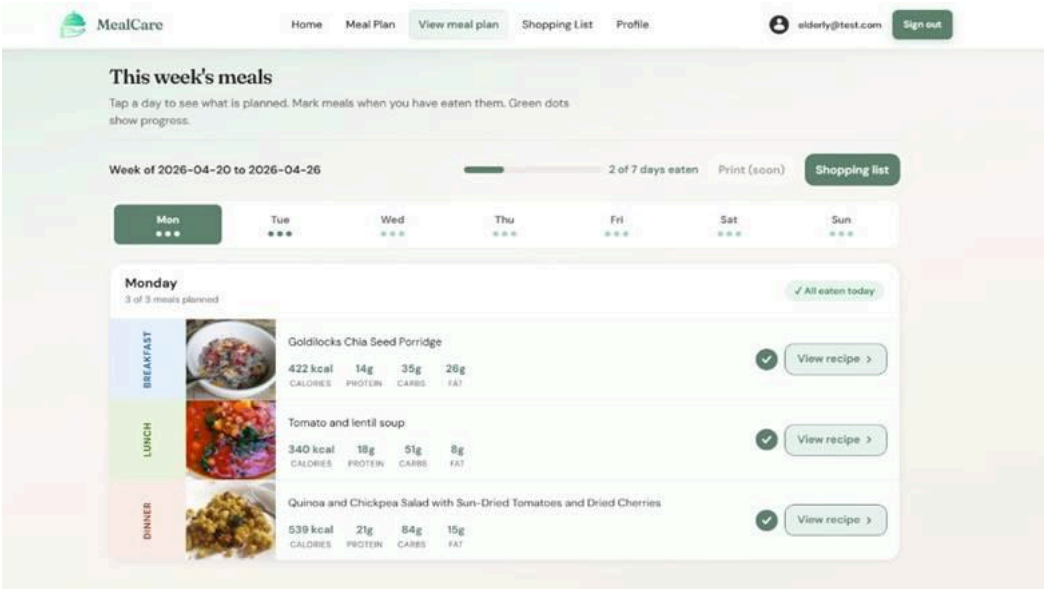
2.2. Meal Plan — lunch options.



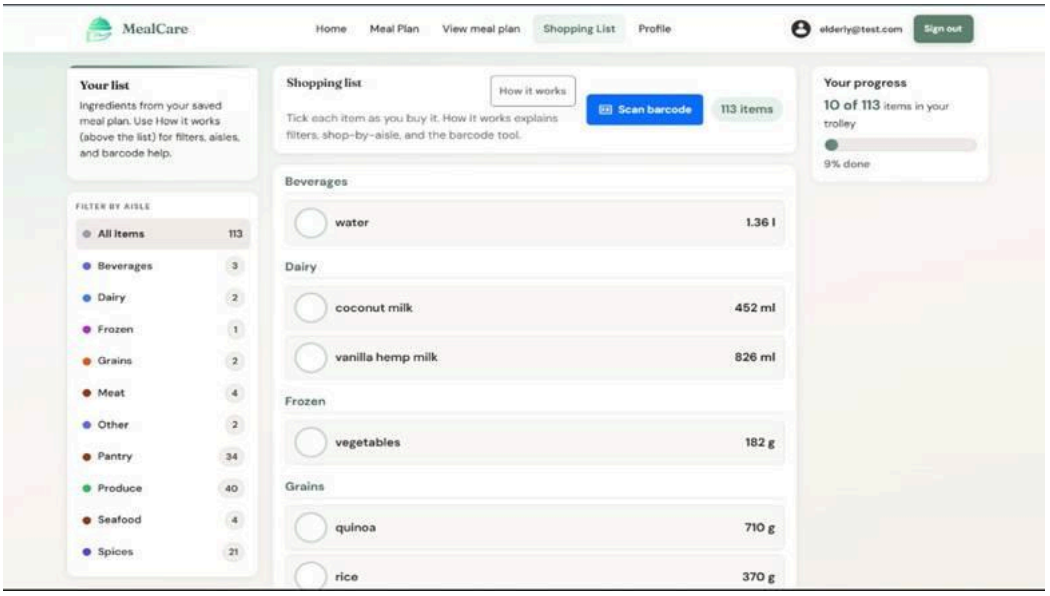
2.3. Meal Plan — dinner options.



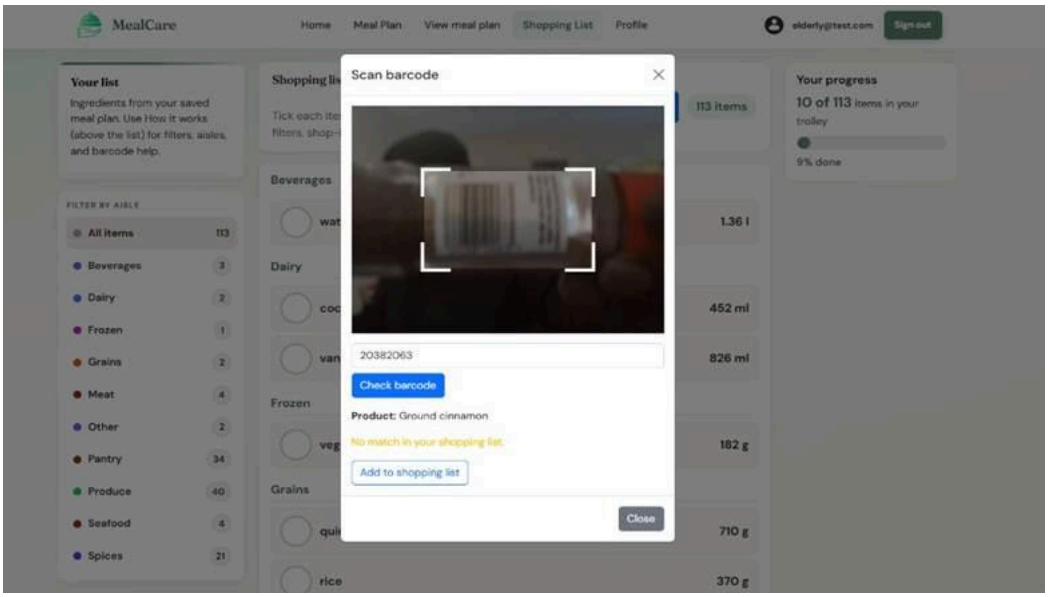
3. View meal plan — this week's meals and nutrition.



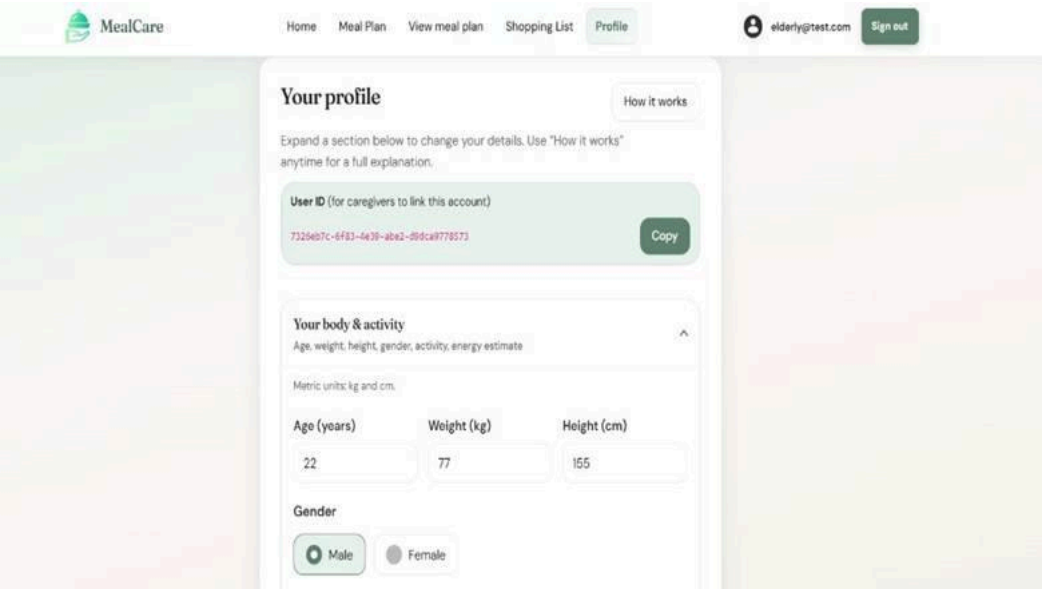
4. Shopping List — aisles and trolley progress.



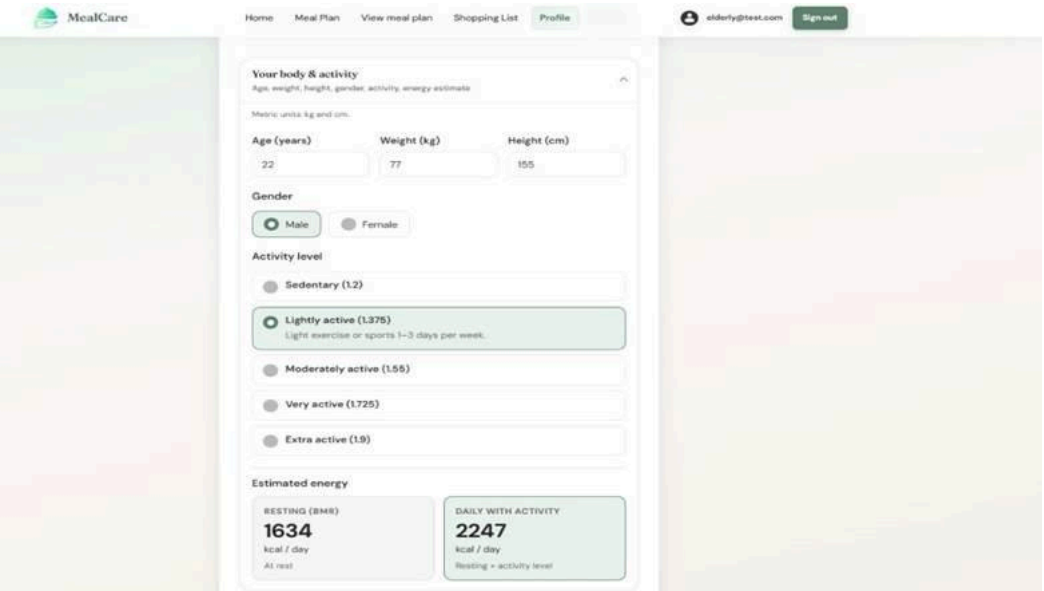
5. Shopping List — scan barcode to check a product.



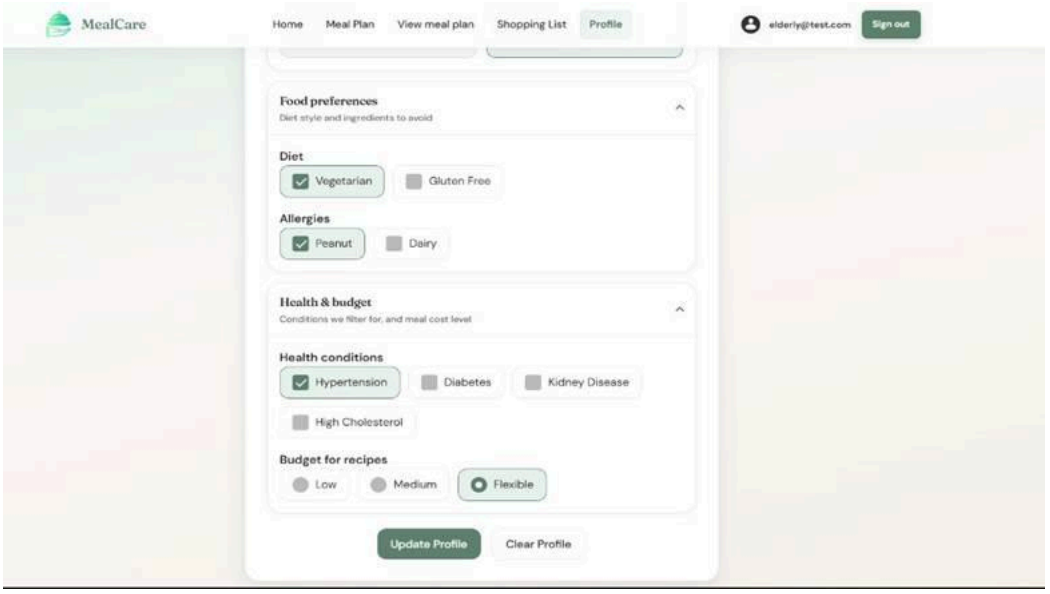
6. Profile — User ID for caregivers to link accounts.



6.1. Profile — body, activity, and energy estimate.



6.2. Profile — diet, allergies, health, budget.



Short video

For Watching video [Click here](#).

Frequently asked questions

Q1. Do I install an app from an app store?

No. MealCare runs directly in your web browser using the provided link.

Q2. Which browsers are supported?

Recent versions of Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Firefox, and Safari are supported.

IQ3. forgot my password. What should I do?

Use the password reset option on the login page and follow the instructions sent to your email.

Q4. Can I use MealCare on my phone?

Yes. The application works on smartphones, tablets, and desktop devices using a web browser.

Q5. Why don’t I see the Caregiving option?
The Caregiving feature is only visible for accounts that are set up as caregivers and linked to a care recipient.

Q6. Do I need to verify my email before logging in?
Yes, depending on system settings, you may need to verify your email address before accessing the application.

Q7. How are meals recommended to me?
Meals are filtered based on your profile, including dietary preferences, allergies, and health conditions.

Q9. Can I change my meal plan after creating it?
Yes, you can modify or replace meals before finalising your weekly plan.

Q10. How is the shopping list created?
The shopping list is automatically generated from the ingredients of the meals you select.

Q11. What happens if a barcode is not recognised?
The system will display an error message and continue to function normally.